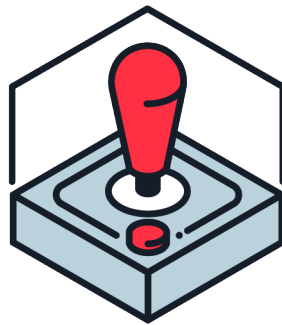


**THE VIDEO GAME
HISTORY FOUNDATION**



Taxonomy of Video Game Development Artifacts

University of Washington Information School
Game Research (GAMER) Group



GAMER
GAME RESEARCH GROUP

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Version History

1.0: 2019, Initial release

1.1: 2020

1.1: December 2024, Formatting update: Updated reference structure for improved visual clarity and ease of use, with no changes to content. Relationships between terms are displayed hierarchically through indentation, with narrower terms shown as subsets of broader terms. Included relevant term relationships (SN, USE, USE FOR, BT, NT, RT) as appropriate.

Introduction

The term 'artifact' is commonly used by game developers and other individuals working in video game production settings, so as to adequately describe the diverse nature of these information objects while simultaneously legitimizing them as objects worthy of preservation and study; based upon literary warrant and a desire to further legitimize these artifacts, we have intentionally chosen to refer to the information objects created and used by game developers as 'artifacts.' Based on the interviews and examination of collections of game development artifacts, we have identified the following types of artifacts, organized into three main categories.

We propose that artifacts are classified at a high level based upon the aspect of game development which they directly relate to. Artifacts which are created and used during the development of a particular game shall be classified under Development, and further classified among the seven listed subfields. Artifacts which are created and used in the organizational context within which games are developed shall be classified under Organization-Related Materials. Artifacts which are created and used while promoting and advertising a completed game shall be classified under Marketing, and further classified among the four listed subfields.

1. Development
 - 1.1 Design (Overall)
 - 1.2 Engineering
 - 1.3 Quality Assurance and Control
 - 1.4 Art
 - 1.5 Audio
 - 1.6 Writing
 - 1.7 Production
2. Organization-Related Materials
3. Marketing
 - 3.1 Marketing (Overall)
 - 3.2 Advertising Materials
 - 3.3 Public Relations
 - 3.4 Promotional Materials

This controlled vocabulary is to be used to classify and describe officially-sanctioned artifacts created at some point during the production and distribution of video games. When considering how to describe artifacts created by fans or other creators which are unaffiliated with the official entity creating a game, please refer to our Best Practices Framework.

Abbreviation Key

The following abbreviations are used throughout:

- SN: Scope note
- USE: Preferred term (See)
- USE FOR: Equivalent term, lead-in term
- BT: Broader term
- NT: Narrower term
- RT: Related term (See also)

1. Development

Artifacts related to the conceptualization, design, and implementation of the digital game itself. We propose that the industry tends to perceive several aspects of development:

1. Design (Overall)
2. Engineering
3. Quality Assurance and Control
4. Art
5. Audio
6. Writing
7. Production

Design (Overall)

Documents which serve as overall guides for the development of digital games. These are not specifically tied to the development of any given element, but offering vision for the entire project.

NT: **Brainstorming Document; Concept Document; Game Bible; Game Design Document (GDD); Research Materials**

Brainstorming Document

SN: Usually informal notes or records regarding the early design thinking for a game.

BT: **Design (Overall)**

Concept Document

SN: This document is an overview which explains a game concept that may be related to the main plot, characters, genre, or gameplay, and may include game art. Sometimes people use **game design document (GDD)** to refer to concept documents.

BT: **Design (Overall)**

Game Bible

SN: A complete (or mostly complete) collection of information about a game's concept, development, and process. This includes concept work such as art, story, narratives, music, code, gameplay, and development. It is a detailed outline to support the construction of the game. A game bible often contains ancillary information about the game world used to make design choices, but which may not appear in-game. In some cases, people do use the term Game Design Document (GDD) to refer to a game bible.

BT: **Design (Overall)**

RT: **Game Design Document; Story Bible**

Game Design Document (GDD)

SN: This is a living document intended to present the game design elements for the purpose of communicating ideas to the development team. Ideally, it is continuously updated to represent the intended final game state although this may not happen due to the nature of the game design environment. The format and maintenance of a **GDD** are dependent on organizational cultures within the originating company and the individuals working within a particular creative team.

USE FOR: **Master Design Document**

BT: **Design (Overall)**

RT: **Game Bible; Concept Document**

Master Design Document

USE: **Game Design Document (GDD)**

Research Materials

SN: Notes and reference materials of any media type intended to inform game design.

BT: **Design (Overall)**

NT: **Audience Research Materials; Consumer Research Materials; Reference Materials**

RT: **Brainstorming Document**

Audience Research Materials

USE: **Consumer Research Materials**

Consumer Research Materials

SN: Materials related to gathering information on a game's intended audience

USE FOR: **Audience Research Materials**

BT: **Research Materials**

Reference Materials

SN: Part of **research materials** that serve a specific purpose of referencing, often in the context of art. For example, photos of buildings in Washington, D.C. may be used as **research materials** to better understand the setting; some of those photos would become **reference materials** when they are selected and passed to artists as references for game art (e.g., animation guidelines, animation reference materials, art reference materials).

BT: **Research Materials**

Engineering

SN: Artifacts related to the technical implementation of a game.

NT: **API Documentation; Build; Build Notes; Code; Executive Review; Game Build; Prototype; Technical Design Document; Technical Schematic**

API Documentation

SN: Reference materials for a game, game platform, or a third party software library regarding its Application Programming Interface (API), which allows other software to interact with it.

BT: **Engineering**

RT: **Technical Design Document**

Build

SN: A compiled version of the game intended for testing or production. While the game state is generally taken from prototype to alpha to beta to release, the specific differences depend on the development environment and based on the level of playability and polish.

USE FOR: **Game Build**

BT: **Engineering**

NT: **Alpha, Beautiful Corner, Beta, Gold Master, Milestone Build, Release, Vertical Slice**

RT: **Build Notes**

Alpha

SN: An early playable **build** to test out different elements of the game.

BT: **Build**

Beautiful Corner

SN: A **build**, usually also a **milestone build**, which demonstrates a small but highly polished sub-section of a digital game.

BT: **Build**

RT: **Vertical Slice**

Beta

SN: A **build** that is close to a finished product and may be shared with a limited number of players (playtesters) for testing and research purposes.

BT: **Build**

RT: **Consumer Research Materials**

Gold Master

A **build** intended to be copied onto a commercial medium (CD, DVD, CART, etc.) for sale to users.

BT: **Build**

RT: **Minimum Viable Product**

Milestone Build

A build produced to satisfy internal requirements attached to a development milestone.

BT: **Build**

Release

SN: A build that is deployed to users.

BT: **Build**

NT: **Minimum Viable Product (MVP), Patch**

Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

RT: **Gold Master**

SN: A release that represents the smallest feature set expected to be viable on the market.

BT: **Release**

Patch

SN: A release intended to partially update a game, often to address bugs.

BT: **Release**

Vertical Slice

SN: A **build**, usually also a **milestone build**, which demonstrates progress across all components of a digital game. (Adapted from Wikipedia).

BT: **Build**

RT: **Beautiful corner**

Build Notes

SN: A set of notes regarding a specific **build**. Often auto-compiled from source control. Focuses on changes between prior builds and the one to which the notes are directly related, such as details of bugs fixed or features added/removed.

BT: **Engineering**

RT: **Build**

Code

SN: A set of machine-readable instructions.

USE FOR: **Script (Code)**

BT: **Engineering**

NT: **Source Code**

Source Code

SN: Code, written in a human-readable language, intended to be transformed by an assembler or compiler into an executable file, used to produce some or all of a digital game

BT: **Code**

Executive Review

SN: Documents, sometimes including a **build**, used for communication between development staff and upper management regarding project progress.

BT: **Engineering**

Game Build

USE: **Build**

Prototype

SN: An artifact reflecting early stage of the work

BT: **Engineering**

NT: **Prototype (Build); Prototype (Paper); Prototype (Technical)**

RT: **Brainstorming Document; Concept Document**

Paper Prototype

USE: **Prototype (Paper)**

Proof of Concept

USE: **Prototype (Build); Prototype (Paper); Prototype (Technical)**

Prototype (Build)

SN: A very early **build** used for testing out the core gameplay as a proof of concept.

USE FOR: **Proof of Concept**

BT: **Prototype**

Prototype (Paper)

SN: An artifact that reflects early work on a game mechanic or feature as a proof of concept.

USE FOR: **Paper Prototype; Proof of Concept**

BT: **Prototype**

Prototype (Technical)

SN: An artifact that reflects early work on game hardware.

USE FOR: **Proof of Concept**

BT: **Prototype**

Script (Code)

USE: **Code**

Technical Design Document

SN: Document detailing the proposed technical solution to the implementation of a digital game.

USE FOR: **Technical Specification**

BT: **Engineering**

RT: **Game Design Document**

Technical Schematic

SN: A technical diagram for a game that runs on dedicated hardware.

BT: **Engineering**

RT: **Technical Design Document**

Technical Specification

USE: **Technical Design Document**

Quality Assurance and Control

SN: A set of artifacts used by QA or QC staff to help developers fix issues in a game.

NT: **Benchmarking Tool; Bug Report; Performance Tool; Playtest Materials**

Benchmarking Tool

SN: A tool, commercial or custom-designed, intended to test the limit of the hardware performance.

BT: **Quality Assurance and Control**

RT: **Performance Tool**

Bug Report

SN: Demonstrates a development issue, usually contrasting expected and experienced results. Shared with designers, developers, and managers who determine a course of action.

BT: **Quality Assurance and Control**

RT: **Build Notes; Patch**

Performance Tool

SN: A tool, commercial or custom-designed, intended to assist with controlled measurement of software performance.

USE FOR: **Telemetry**

BT: **Quality Assurance and Control**

RT: **Benchmarking Too**

Playtest Materials

SN: Materials related to the testing process, aiming to identify problems with the digital game via gameplay and feedback (e.g., playtest notes, playtest questionnaire, playtest comments).

USE FOR: **User Test**

BT: **Quality Assurance and Control**

RT: **Consumer Research Materials**

Telemetry

USE: **Performance Tool**

User Test

USE: **Playtest Materials**

Art

SN: Artifacts related to the visual design of a digital game. Can include UI, character, environmental, animation, and brand/marketing elements, as well as typeface selection or design.

NT: **Animatic; Art Asset; Art Bible; Art Notes; Concept Art; Industrial Design Materials; Logo; Representative Art; Ripomatic; Screenshot; Storyboard; Typography Document**

Animatic

SN: Animated versions of storyboards to capture data that cannot be conveyed as well in storyboards (animation, flow, changes).

BT: **Art**

RT: **Ripomatic; Storyboard**

Art Asset

SN: Any artwork used in a released version of the video game, such as 3D models or 2D artwork (e.g., mesh, model, render, sprite, texture, wireframe).

USE FOR: **Graphic; Illustration; In-game Art Asset**

BT: **Art**

Art Bible

SN: A reference guide that contains details regarding the game's appearance. Often authored by an art director to help artists maintain consistency. Can include concept art, sketches, photographs, completed assets, and reference materials. Generally intended to be a complete reference to the look and feel of a video game.

USE FOR: **Visual Style Guide**

BT: **Art**

RT: **Game Bible**

Art Notes

SN: Notes regarding specific assets, art pieces, or scenes within a game, intended to provide context for artwork, animation, or other visual concepts.

BT: **Art**

Box Art

USE: **Representative Art**

Bullshot

USE: **Screenshot**

Concept Art

SN: Sketches or completed artworks, often with notes, intended to provide visual concepts for levels, characters, or other game elements (e.g., drawing, scan, sketch, illustration, graphic).

USE FOR: **Concept Work**

BT: **Art**

RT: **Concept Document**

Emblem

USE: **Logo**

Font

USE: **Typography Document**

Graphic

USE: **Art Asset**

Illustration

USE: **Art Asset**

Industrial Design Materials

SN: Materials related to the industrial production of games, often used in reference to coin-op game boxes.

BT: **Art**

In-game Art Asset

USE: **Art Asset**

Key Art

USE: **Representative Art**

Logo

SN: A symbol or other design intended to represent a video game company or its products.

USE FOR: **Emblem; Logotype**

BT: **Art**

RT: **Representative Art**

Logotype

USE: **Logo**

Packaging Art

USE: **Representative Art**

Packshot

USE: **Representative Art**

Promotional Art

USE: **Representative Art**

Representative Art

SN: The officially released images prominently featured in a physical or digital distribution package of the video game (including all sides of the package) (e.g., jacket, jewel case, poster).

USE FOR: **Box Art; Key Art; Packaging Art; Packshot; Promotional Art**

BT: **Art**

RT: **Logo**

Ripomatic

SN: Clips of existing media (e.g., games or movies) that capture a feel for the game without directly referencing any of the game's assets

BT: **Art.**

RT: **Animatic; Storyboard**

Screen Capture

USE: **Screenshot**

Screenshot

SN: Image captured from a game during play (sometimes faked: “bullshot”).

USE FOR: **Bullshot; Screen Capture**

BT: **Art**

Storyboard

SN: A graphic organization in a sequence used for planning scenes.

BT: **Art**

RT: **Animatic; Ripomatic**

Typeface

USE: **Typography Document**

Typography Document

SN: A document describing the style, appearance, and organization of typefaces

USE FOR: **Font; Typeface**

BT: **Art**

Visual Style Guide

USE: **Art Bible**

Audio

SN: Artifacts related to the sound design of a digital game.

NT: **Audio Asset; Score; Voice Acting Artifact**

Audio Asset

SN: All audio assets that make up the discourse or sound effects in the game.

USE FOR: **Audio Effect; Audio File; Audio Sample; Digital Record; Discourse;**

Environmental Audio; Sound Effect; Submix

BT: **Audio**

NT: **Composition, Dialogue, Soundtrack**

Audio Track

USE: **Composition**

Conversation

USE: **Dialogue**

Composition

USE FOR: **Audio Track; Game Soundtrack; Music; Original Soundtrack**

Dialogue

SN: Audio of extended discourse in a video game.

USE FOR: **Conversation; Discourse; Voiceover**

BT: **Audio Asset**

Discourse

USE: **Dialogue**

Game Soundtrack

USE: Composition

Music

USE: Composition

Original Soundtrack

USE: Composition

Soundtrack

SN: An original piece of music in which long or extended audio is used, often in the back ground to add to the mood of the game (e.g., song, background music).

BT: **Audio Asset**

Voiceover

USE: Dialogue

Audio Effect

USE: **Audio Asset**

Audio File

USE: **Audio Asset**

Audio Sample

USE: **Audio Asset**

Audition

USE: **Voice Acting Artifact**

Casting Call

USE: **Voice Acting Artifact**

Digital Record

USE: **Audio Asset**

Environmental Audio

USE: **Audio Asset**

Score

SN: A written form of a composition.

USE FOR: **Sheet Music**

BT: **Audio**

RT: **Composition**

Session Tape

USE: **Voice Acting Artifact**

Sheet Music

USE: **Score**

Sound Effect

USE: **Audio Asset**

Submix

USE: **Audio Asset**

Voice Acting Artifact

SN: Information related to voice performers and performances (e.g. name of voice actors/actresses, audio samples, takes, etc.)

USE FOR: **Audition; Casting Call; Session Tape; Voice Test**

BT: **Audio**

RT: **Dialogue; Script (Narrative)**

Voice Test

USE: **Voice Acting Artifact**

Writing

SN: Artifacts related to the narrative design of a digital game.

NT: **Linguistic Style Guide; Localization Document; Setting Documentation; Script (Narrative); Story Bible**

Linguistic Style Guide

SN: A guide that contains details of textual/linguistic structure, including dialect, slang, etc. Developed as a reference for script authors.

BT: **Writing**

RT: **Reference Materials**

Localization Document

SN: Document providing information regarding the translation of a digital game from a source language into one or more additional languages.

BT: **Writing**

Lore Documentation

USE: **Setting Documentation**

Point of Interest Information

USE: **Setting Documentation**

Setting Documentation

SN: Information about the world or environment of a game.

USE FOR: **Point of Interest Information; Lore Documentation**

BT: **Writing**

Script (Narrative)

SN: Not to be confused with script (code). As in cinema or radio, but for a digital game. Text that could be used for the recording of voice actors/actresses, or for on-screen written text. May be single lines, an entire digital game, or anything in between.

BT: **Writing**

RT: **Voice Acting Artifact**

Story Bible

SN: A complete (or mostly complete) collection of information about a game's narrative. This includes work such as backstories, character treatments, and other elements that creative writer(s) can generate which will be referenced in the **narrative design document**.

BT: **Writing**

NT: **Narrative Design Document**

RT: **Game Bible**

Narrative Activity Flow

USE: **Narrative Design Document**

Narrative Design Document

SN: A flow chart, diagram, or text description representing the progression of dialog, story elements, or plot.

USE FOR: **Narrative Activity Flow; Narrative Structure Document; Story Bible**

BT: **Story Bible**

Narrative Structure Document

USE: **Narrative Design Document**

Production

SN: Artifacts related to the logistical management of game development processes.

NT: **Asset Archive; Budget (Game); Burndown Chart (Agile); Focus Group Materials; Pitch Document; Postmortem; Schedule**

Asset Archive

SN: List of all of the resources of one type required to complete a game design, often with production tracking information included. May apply to art, code, narrative, audio, or other resource types. Active/in progress versions are often referred to as an **inventory** and/or a **list**.

USE FOR: **Inventory (of a specific resource type such as Art, Code, etc.)**

BT: **Production**

Backlog

USE: **Schedule**

Budget (Game)

SN: An estimate of income, expenditure, and/or amount of resources to be used for a particular purpose in developing games. May include information on many types of resources: employee labor, marketing, etc.

BT: **Production**

RT: **Budget (Organization)**

Burndown Chart (Agile)

SN: Shows the actual amount of work completed, usually contrasted with the original schedule of work.

BT: **Production**

RT: **Burndown Chart (Finance); Schedule**

Focus Group Materials

SN: Documents or records regarding the use of focus groups to discuss game features, including the planning documents and notes from focus group sessions.

BT: **Production**

RT: **Consumer Research Materials**

Inventory (of a specific resource type such as Art, Code, etc.)

USE: **Asset Archive**

Pitch Document

SN: The goal of this document is to convince stakeholders to support the development of the game in some way. It may include some basic concepts of the game (e.g., plot, characters, genre, gameplay), information about its potential audience, market analysis and budget, and engineering detail.

USE FOR: **Proposal Document**

BT: **Production**

Postmortem

SN: Records of a post-milestone, post-launch, or post-cancellation review of the game creation process, including insights on what went wrong and right.

BT: **Production**

Proposal Document

USE: **Pitch Document**

Roadmap

USE: **Schedule**

Schedule

SN: Information regarding deadlines and milestones for a project.

USE FOR: **Backlog; Roadmap**

BT: **Production**

RT: **Burndown Chart (Agile)**

2. Organization-Related Artifacts

These documents are commonly in archives and potentially important to understanding game development context by offering information about the parent organization.

Board of Directors Materials

SN: Materials related to the membership and performance of the organization's board of directors.

Business Plan

SN: Documents detailing a company's strategic goals and the tactics intended to achieve them

RT: **Company Culture Document**

Communication Documentation

SN: Documentary traces of communication among game developers, game development organizations, cultural heritage institutions, and other entities.

Communication App Archive

SN: A log or other archive of the communication hosted by an application that facilitates communication at the organization, such as Slack or Discord.

BT: **Communication Documentation**

Correspondence (External)

SN: Communication between two or more individuals, at least one of which is not inside the organization.

BT: **Communication Documentation**

Correspondence (Internal)

SN: Communication between two or more individuals, all of which are inside the organization.

BT: **Communication Documentation**

Company Culture Document

SN: Reflects and showcases the personality of the company including its mission and core values, goals, and work environment. (e.g., mission statement, newsletter, annual report).

Company Ephemera

SN: Organization-related items generated for short-term usefulness (e.g., business cards, holiday cards)

Financial Documents

SN: Documents related to the company's monetary resources and affairs.

NT: **Budget (Organization); Burndown Chart (Finance); Profit and Loss Statement; Receipt; Royalty Statement; Sales Data; Shareholder Report; Stock Certificate**

Budget (Organization)

SN: An estimate of income, expenditure, and/or amount of resources to be used for a particular purpose.

BT: **Financial Documents**

RT: **Budget (Game)**

Burndown Chart (Finance)

SN: Shows the actual expenditure of budgeted resources, usually contrasted with the original budget.

BT: **Financial Documents**

RT: **Budget (Game); Burndown Chart (Agile)**

Profit and Loss Statement

SN: A financial report covering income and expenses for a set period of time.

BT: **Financial Documents**

Receipt

SN: A document acknowledging the exchange of goods or money.

BT: **Financial Documents**

RT: **Contract**

Royalty Statement

SN: A report intended for royalty rights holders regarding money owed to them for use of their work or intellectual property.

BT: **Financial Documents**

Sales Data

SN: Information pertaining to income from a digital game.

USE FOR: **Sales Report**

BT: **Financial Documents**

Sales Report

USE: **Sales Data**

Shareholder Report

SN: A report produced by a publicly held company intended to summarize business activity for a given financial year, intended for use by current and future investors as well as government regulators.

BT: **Financial Documents**

Stock Certificate

SN: A document acknowledging ownership of one or more shares of the stock of a corporation.

BT: **Financial Documents**

RT: **IPO document**

Human Resources Materials

SN: Materials that are used for recruiting, hiring, and on-boarding new employees (e.g., job listing, resumes, organization chart, performance reviews, salary structures).

USE FOR: **Recruiting Materials**

IPO Document

SN: A document related to the initial public offering of a corporation.

RT: **Shareholder Report; Stock Certificate**

Keepsake

An artifact representing a memorable event or achievement for the organization (e.g., clippings, awards, memento).

RT: **Company Ephemera**

Legal Documents

SN: Documents related to the company's legal affairs.

NT: **Cease & Desist; Contract; Copyright Document; Due Diligence Document; Patent Document; Statement of Work; Trademark Document; Third-Party Software Report (TPS Report)**

Cease & Desist

SN: An order directing someone to stop engaging in a particular activity (derived from Oxford dictionary).

BT: **Legal Documents**

Contract

SN: A binding agreement between two or more persons or parties, intended to be legally enforceable (e.g., employment contract, marketing agreement, noncompete agreement, non-disclosure agreement).

BT: **Legal Documents**

Copyright Document

SN: Regards the application for a copyright or the granting of one.

BT: **Legal Documents**

Due Diligence Document

SN: Documents tracking the organization's adherence to contractual or legal obligations.

BT: **Legal Documents**

Patent Document

SN: Regards the application for a patent or the granting of one.

BT: **Legal Documents**

Statement of Work

SN: Documents detailing work to be performed by a third party, often as part of a contract.

BT: **Legal Documents**

RT: **Contract; Receipt**

Trademark Document

SN: Regards the application for a trademark or the granting of one.

BT: **Legal Documents**

Third-Party Software Report (TPS Report)

SN: A progress or status report from a third party.

BT: **Legal Documents**

Operational Materials

SN: Artifacts generated during the regular day-to-day operations within the company (e.g., meeting notes, presentation slides).

Recruiting Materials

USE: **Human Resources Materials**

3. Marketing

Materials related to the selling of a game through earned, paid, and owned media. We propose that the industry tends to perceive several aspects of marketing:

1. Marketing (Overall)
2. Advertising Materials
3. Public Relations

Marketing (Overall)

SN: Documents which serve as overall guides for the marketing of digital games.

NT: **Community Management Plan; Convention Materials; Customer Service Document; Derivative Media; Feelie; Lecture; Marketing Plan; Merchandise; Social Media Archive; Social Media Plan; Strategy Guide; Teacher's Guide; Trailer**

Advertising Plan

USE: **Marketing Plan**

Community Management Plan

SN: Internal planning documents related to community management efforts.

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

Conference Materials

USE: **Convention Materials**

Convention Materials

SN: Materials related to a trade or consumer show at which the game was represented in some fashion. May include materials used during the show (parts of a company booth or promotional "swag") or records of the event (photographs, videos, receipts, notes).

USE FOR: **Conference Materials**

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

RT: **Lecture**

Customer Service Document

SN: Artifacts related to official company interaction with the public, including information to be shared, policies regarding interaction, and records of interaction (e.g., guidelines for interacting with players, fan mail).

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

Derivative Media

SN: Licensed media goods related to the game's intellectual property.

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

Feelie

SN: A physical item intended to make the game feel more "real" to players (e.g., the cloth map in Ultima 2). Some function as copy protection, wherein players need the specific physical object to play the game.

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

Lecture

SN: A record (text, audio, or video) of a public appearance of one or more people related to a digital game, often from a conference, convention, or consumer show.

USE FOR: **Talk; Panel**

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

Licensed Product

USE: **Merchandise**

Marketing Plan

SN: Documents coordinating or organizing marketing activities.

USE FOR: **PR Plan; Advertising Plan**

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

RT: **Marketing Road Map; Social Media Plan**

Merch

USE: **Merchandise**

Merchandise

SN: Physical goods related to the game's intellectual property. Could be given away free (as a promotion) or offered for sale.

USE FOR: **Licensed Product; Merch**

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

Panel

USE: **Lecture**

PR Plan

USE: **Marketing Plan**

Social Media Archive

SN: A log or other archive of the interactions from a social media platform, such as Facebook or Twitter.

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

RT: **Social Media Plan**

Social Media Plan

SN: Internal planning documents related to marketing efforts through social media platforms, such as Facebook or Twitter.

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

RT: **Social Media Archive**

Strategy Guide

SN: Documents that are intended to help players progress through the game by explaining the necessary actions and other gameplay relevant information (e.g., tips, tricks, cheats, FAQs).

USE FOR: **Walkthrough**

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

Talk

USE: **Lecture**

Teacher's Guide

SN: Materials distributed to educators to facilitate the use in classrooms or with learners.

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

Trailer

SN: An edited selection of scenes that advertise a digital game.

BT: **Marketing (Overall)**

Walkthrough

USE: **Strategy Guide**

Advertising Materials

SN: Artifacts related to public marketing of games, game-related products, or services in any medium.

NT: **Creative Brief; Game Catalog; Key Art; Packaging; Promotional Materials; Retail Support Materials**

Contest

USE: **Promotional Materials**

Creative Brief

SN: Document created by the game producer for the sake of their advertising department or third-party agency, intended to help with the production of advertising and marketing materials.

BT: **Advertising Materials**

Game Catalog

SN: A list of games published (or intended to be published) by the organization.

USE FOR: **Price List**

BT: **Advertising Materials**

Giveaway

USE: **Promotional Materials**

Key Art

SN: Art used for the marketing and promotion of a video game (e.g., poster).

BT: **Advertising Materials**

RT: **Packaging**

Packaging

SN: The box and other materials accompanying a game when packed for physical distribution.

BT: **Advertising Materials**

RT: **Key Art**

Point of Purchase

USE: **Retail Support Materials**

Price List

USE: **Game Catalog**

Promotional Materials

SN: Documents and artifacts related to promoting games, game companies, or game related events such as a public contest or sweepstakes.

USE FOR: **Contest; Giveaway; Swag; Sweepstakes**

BT: **Advertising Materials**

RT: **Retail Support Materials**

Retail Display

USE: **Retail Support Materials**

Retail Support Materials

SN: Materials provided (free or paid) to retailers to support sales, intended to be used for in-store promotion. Common types include posters, standees, and retailer guidelines.

USE FOR: **Point of Purchase; Retail Display**

BT: **Advertising Materials**

RT: **Promotional Materials**

Swag

USE: **Promotional Materials**

Sweepstakes

USE: **Promotional Materials**

Public Relations

Materials specifically given to press for promoting the game.

NT: **Biography; Company Profile; Fact Sheet; Interview; Membership List; Press Kit; Press Materials; Reviewer Guidelines**

Article

USE: **Press Materials**

Biography

SN: A profile of a person associated with the game or parent company. May include photos.

BT: **Public Relations**

Clipping

USE: **Press Materials**

Company Profile

SN: A document that provides information related to the company—such as company size, financial information, and company history—rather than the game itself. Almost always supplemental materials sent alongside other press documents.

BT: **Public Relations**

Fact Sheet

SN: A press document that gives bullet point specifics about a specific product or announcement. Usually literally titled “Fact Sheet”.

BT: **Public Relations**

Interview

SN: A record (text, audio, or video) of a discussion with one or more people related to a digital game, often hosted by internal marketing staff or members of the press.

BT: **Public Relations**

Membership List

SN: Records of an official mailing list, email or snail mail, with recipient names and addresses.

BT: **Public Relations**

Press Clipping

USE: **Press Materials**

Press Coverage

USE: **Press Materials**

Press Kit

SN: A collection of materials intended for distribution to members of the press.

BT: **Public Relations**

Press Materials

SN: Information provided to the media or produced by the media.

USE FOR: **Article; Clipping; Press Clipping; Press Coverage; Press Release**

BT: **Public Relations**

Press Release

USE: **Press Materials**

Reviewer Guidelines

SN: A document distributed to game reviewers to help them understand the game and write reviews.

BT: **Public Relations**